NUDGES

JDM (PSYC10) 2026

EMILY ZOHAR & DASHA SANDRA

ABOUT ME

TA:
Emily Zohar

RESEARCH:
How context impacts effort willingness

EXPERIENCE:
Worked for a behavioural economics consulting firm

TODAY

1. WHAT IS A NUDGE
2. NUDGES IN THE REAL WORLD
3. LIMITATIONS
4. WHO IMPLEMENTS NUDGES

NUDGE

Any aspect of the choice architecture that **alters people's behaviour in a predictable way without forbidding any options** or significantly changing their economic incentives

(THALER & SUNSTEIN, 2022)

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(THALER & SUNSTEIN, 2022)

LIBERTARIAN no options are restricted or forced upon you

PATERNALISTIC choice architects have your best interests at heart

NUDGE

INITIAL CONCERNS

Any aspect of the choice architecture that **alters people's behaviour in a predictable way without forbidding any options** or significantly changing their economic incentives

(THALER & SUNSTEIN, 2022)

MANIPULATIVE: who’s benefiting from the nudge?

TRANSPARENCY: uncomfortable with behaviour being changed without knowledge or consent

NUDGE

Any aspect of the choice architecture that **alters people's behaviour in a predictable way without forbidding any options** or significantly changing their economic incentives

(THALER & SUNSTEIN, 2022)

Am I free to make another choice without restriction, penalty, or excessive reward?

Does this intervention **prioritize my best interests**, not someone else's gain?

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(THALER & SUNSTEIN, 2022)

01. IDENTIFY THE SPECIFIC BEHAVIOUR YOU'D LIKE TO CHANGE.

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04. CHANGE ENVIRONMENT IN A WAY THAT INCREASES DESIRED BEHAVIOUR.

IS IT A NUDGE?

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~~LIBERTARIAN~~

PATERNALISTIC

IS IT A NUDGE?

LIBERTARIAN
PATERNALISTIC

01. IDENTIFY THE SPECIFIC BEHAVIOUR YOU'D LIKE TO CHANGE.

Traffic jams coming in and out of the subway

02. WHY IS THE BEHAVIOUR HAPPENING?

People are entering before others leave the train

03. WHAT ENVIRONMENTAL INFLUENCES ARE FACILITATING OR INHIBITING THE BEHAVIOUR?

People don't know where to stand

04. CHANGE ENVIRONMENT IN A WAY THAT INCREASES DESIRED BEHAVIOUR.

Stickers direct people where to stand

IS IT A NUDGE?

LIBERTARIAN

~~**PATERNALISTIC**~~

IS IT A NUDGE?

LIBERTARIAN
PATERNALISTIC

01. IDENTIFY THE SPECIFIC BEHAVIOUR YOU'D LIKE TO CHANGE.

Maintain accurate data

02. WHY IS THE BEHAVIOUR HAPPENING?

People don't turn off their show when they're no longer watching

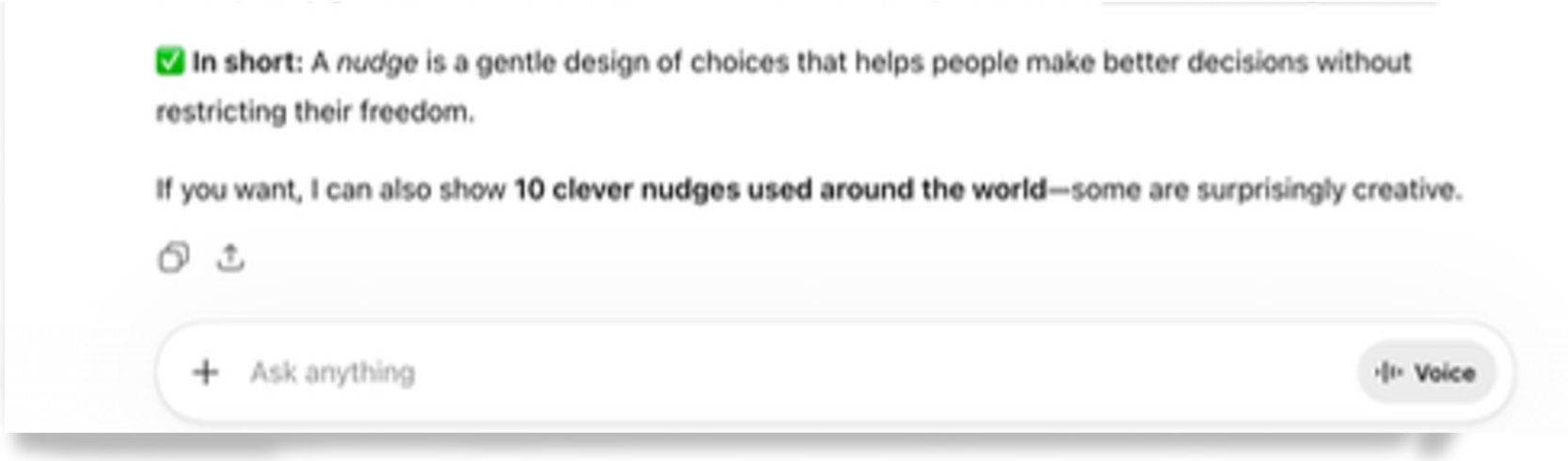
03. WHAT ENVIRONMENTAL INFLUENCES ARE FACILITATING OR INHIBITING THE BEHAVIOUR?

Episodes play automatically

04. CHANGE ENVIRONMENT IN A WAY THAT INCREASES DESIRED BEHAVIOUR.

Add an alert to ensure individuals are still watching

IS IT A NUDGE?



LIBERTARIAN PATERNALISTIC?

ANY OTHER EXAMPLES?

WHO MAKES NUDGES?

CHOICE ARCHITECTS: Someone who frames information and designs the presentation of choices.

CHOICE ARCHITECTURE

THE DELIBERATE CRAFTING OF HOW DECISIONS ARE PRESENTED

We make countless decisions everyday so we rely on biases and heuristics. This makes how options are displayed very impactful.

ORDER OF FOOD IN A CAFETERIA

The **salience** and **accesibility** of the food impacts what will be chosen most often.

75%

of diners selected the first food they saw

66%

of all the foods a person took came from the first three foods they encountered in the buffet.

WANSINK ET AL. (2013)

SALIENCE

DRAWS ATTENTION TO SPECIFIC INFORMATION TO MAKE THEM MORE LIKELY TO BE SELECTED OR REMEMBERED

FOOD WASTE

BE*works*

Low food salience, or difficulty noticing and keeping track of remaining foods

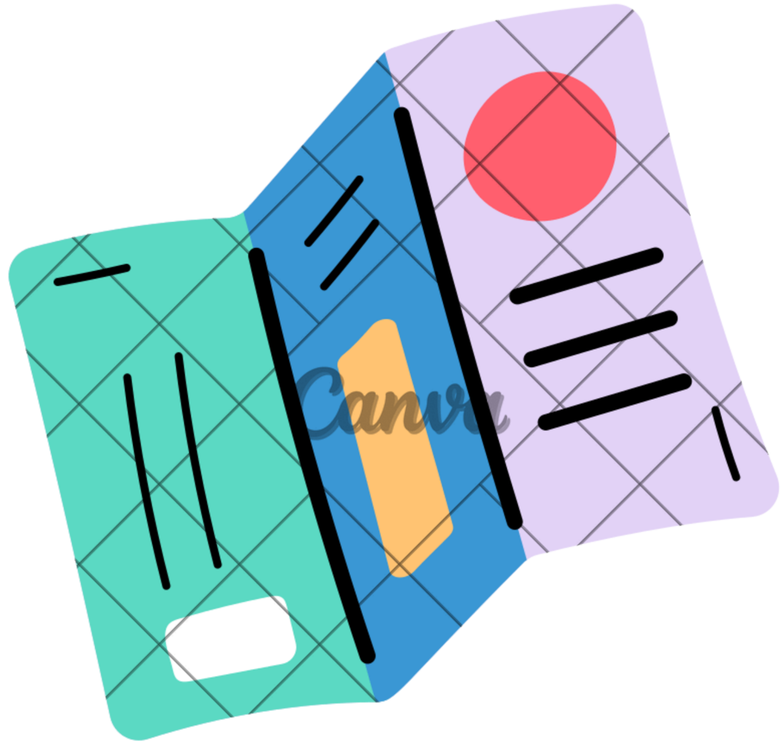
increasing food salience

FRAMING

EQUIVALENT INFORMATION CAN BE
MORE OR LESS ATTRACTIVE DEPENDING
ON WHAT FEATURES ARE HIGHLIGHTED.

MARKETING

BEworks



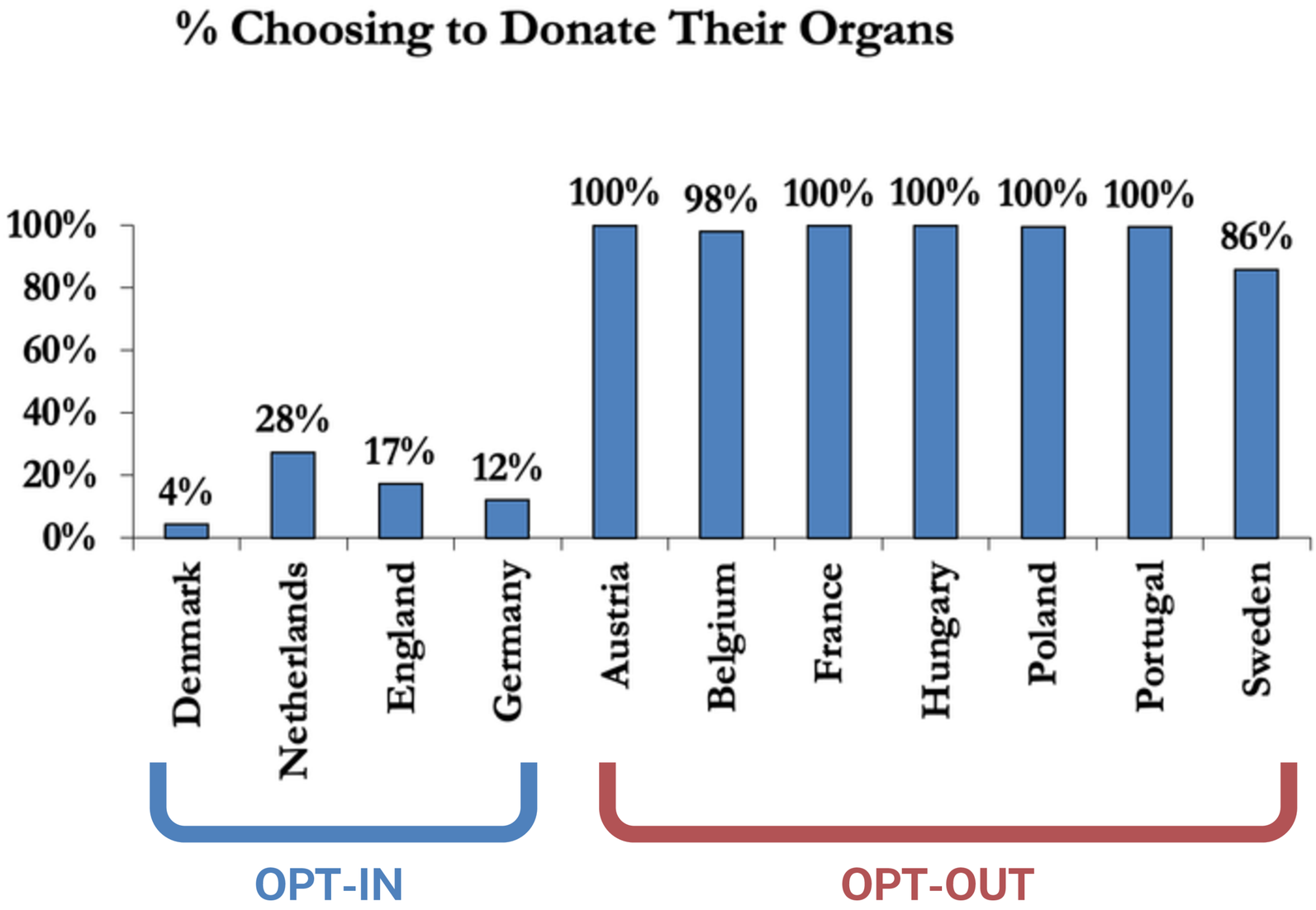
DEFAULTS

THE CHOICE THAT WILL BE IMPLEMENTED IF YOU DON’T MAKE A DECISION FOR YOURSELF

Defaults are unavoidable - all decisions must offer a default

Choice architects must decide what the default is

ORGAN DONATION



JOHNSON & GOLDSTEIN (2004)

DEFAULTS

WHY DO THEY WORK?

MECHANICAL REASONS

- Transaction costs
- Decision costs
- Procrastination/Forgetting
- Unawareness

PSYCHOLOGICAL REASONS

- Regret (more potential regret from an action than an inaction)
- Lack of reasons for making an active choice

BELIEF-BASED REASONS

- Recommendation (this is what policy makers are recommending)
- Social Norm (that’s what everyone does)
- Prescriptive Norm (that’s the right decision)

DEFAULTS

THE IMPORTANCE OF DEFAULTS

They are...

UNAVOIDABLE

OFTEN VIEWED AS NORM/RECOMMENDATION

EXTREMELY STICKY

So if you are a policy maker, it’s important to choose the default carefully!